NLP703 Syllabus Update

(effective, March 17, 2026)

Old assessment distribution:

#	Assessment Type	Description	Weighting %	Mapping to CLO
1	Project	Students will be evaluated on the following: • Project final report (20%) • Project Presentation (10%) • Individual participation in the project (10%) - assessed based on self report and peer feedback.	40	'NLP703 - Speech Processing - Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) - 3,4,5'
2	Mid-term Exam	Mid-term exam will cover the topics covers in weeks 1 to 6.	30	'NLP703 - Speech Processing - Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) - 1,2'
3	In-class Participation	Students are expected to show up and participate in class. Formative pop quizzes and peer evaluation forms will be used to assess participation.	10	'NLP703 - Speech Processing - Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) - 1,2,5'
4	Lab - Active Participation	Students are required to show up in labs and completed the assigned exercises. The evaluation is based on completion of all lab activities.	20	'NLP703 - Speech Processing - Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) - 2,3'

New assessment distribution:

#	Assessment Type	Description	Weighting %	Mapping to CLO
1	Project	Individual or group project. See Rubric/details below.	40	3,4,5
2	**Midterm Exam**	The exam will be conducted remotely using Inspera browser	**20**	1,2
3	In-class Participation	In-class quizzes and other forms of participation	10	1,2,5
4	Lab – Active participation	Participation and completion of lab activities	20	2,3
5	**Online attendance**	Attendance in online class sessions.	**10**	2,3

Project Guidelines:

1. List your project ideas/teams in this shared sheet
2. You can have a team of up to 3 students (within the same class, NLP703). You can also work individually, but group projects are strongly preferred.
3. Your project deliverables include the following
    a. **20% project report:** this should be written up clearly, describing the project idea, methodology, results, and discussion. This should also include a link to the implementation in github or as an attachment; the code should be well documented and replicable.

b. **10% project presentation:** the final form of the presentation will be shared later (either as a recording or a live online session).
c. **10% individual portfolio:** Keep track of your individual work and progress throughout the project. This should show the work and thinking process, like a journal, detailing your individual contribution to the project.

Project Report Rubric (20 points total)

Description	Lacking	Developing	Exemplary
Clarity, writing, and formatting	The report is badly formatted, lacks clarity and structure, and hard to follow. Lacking depth of discussion. **0-2 pts**	The report is decent but could be improved in terms of clarity, formatting, structure, or depth of discussion. **3-4 pts**	The report is well written and professionally formatted, with all aspects of the project clearly documented and discussed in depth. **5 pts**
Methodology	The project is incomplete, or the scope of the project is not suitable for the course and/or the methodology has serious conceptual shortcomings. **0-4 pts**	The project's methodology is mostly sound, but some aspects of the design, evaluation, or choice of data, are questionable. **5-8 pts**	The project describes a well defined idea in speech processing, the methodology is sound, with the appropriate scope, use of relevant data and resources, modeling choices are well justified and explained, and outcomes are evaluated using appropriate metrics. **9-10 pts.**
Implementation	Code not included, or included but unusable due to bugs or lack of documentation. **0-2 pts**	The implementation is included but lacks clear documentation or some parts cannot be replicated. **3-4**	The implementation is included, it's well documented and formatted, and can be replicated. **5 pts**

Project Presentation Rubric (10 points total)

Lacking	Developing	Exemplary
The presentation is not given, or it is severely lacking in terms of quality and clarity. **0-4 pts**	The presentation is clear enough, but could be improved in terms of quality of material, engagement, or clarity of explanations. **5-8 pts**	The presentation is clear, engaging, and well structured. All questions are answered appropriately. **9-10 pts**

Individual Project Portfolio (10 points)

Description	Lacking	Developing	Exemplary
Clarity and completion	The portfolio is not submitted, or lacks structure/depth that makes it uninformative. **0-2 pts**	The portfolio lacks sufficient temporal details (i.e., appears to be done at the end rather than throughout the project) **3-4 pts**	The portfolio is complete and is presented clearly. It includes reflection of progress, challenges, and learning process throughout the project. **4 pts**
Strength of contribution and reflection	The contribution to the project is relatively poor, and the reflection shows lack of engagement with the project and the learning process **0-2**	N/A	The contribution is fair or large relative to other group members, and the reflection shows deep engagement with the project and the learning process **3-4 pts**
AI use disclosure and reflection on limitations/ethics.	The report lacks disclosure about the process used (Whether AI is used or not) and lack of reflection on the limitations/ethics of using AI in this context. **0 pts**	N/A	The project includes fully transparent disclosure of AI use throughout the project (if it's used) and/or reflection on shortcomings/views related to the ethics or limitations of using AI in this context. **2 pts**